

Mizan-TEPI UNIVERSITY

- GAT TRAINING SESSION ON:
VERBAL REASONING

Prepared by Post graduate office
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Content Outline

- ❖ Introduction
- ❖ Analogy
- ❖ Classification: & letter classification
- ❖ Word relationship: semantic relation- antonym and synonym, Choosing the odd pair of words (134) ,146
- ❖ coding – word coding and number coding 185
- ❖ Reading comprehension

Introduction to verbal reasoning

❖ What is verbal reasoning ?

- Verbal reasoning can be defined as the ability to understand and comprehend concepts expressed through language, think constructively and apply logic to solve problems.
- Verbal reasoning goes beyond recognizing vocabulary or language fluency to how we understand, reason, and engage with written and verbal language.

In the absence of understanding Language may declare worse and in the presence of understanding and language may declare otherwise and understanding is a base for taking action with confidence. In all these issues verbal reasoning is always with us. For example

Introduction to verbal reasoning

- ❖ We Follow instructions and decipher a solution
- ❖ We struggle to Understand letter sequences
- ❖ We draw conclusions from limited information
- ❖ Spotting the odd word in a group

Continued

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❖ **Why is verbal reasoning important?**

- ❖ It is an important skill that we begin to develop in childhood. When a child asks ‘why?’, ‘why not?’, ‘how come?’, they are using their verbal reasoning skills: it helps them develop perception, understanding.
- ❖ As adults, verbal reasoning is something we use every day, often without realizing, whether we are relaying key pieces of information from a news article to a friend or having a debate with a colleague.
- ❖ Verbal reasoning is a particularly important skill in the workplace in many different sectors and industries; even those you might not immediately think of as requiring strong verbal skills.

Continued

When is verbal reasoning test given?

- ❖ Verbal reasoning tests are most commonly used in the recruitment process for entry-level positions, such as graduate schemes and internships, however, they can also be used for more senior roles.
- ❖ You may also be required to take a verbal reasoning test as part of the entrance examinations used by schools, colleges, and universities

Analogy

What does verbal reasoning include?

1. Analogy-means correspondence

In questions based on analogy, a particular relationship is given and another similar relationship has to be identified from the alternatives provided. Analogy tests are therefore meant to test a candidates' overall knowledge, power of reasoning and ability to think concisely and accurately. Let us see some common relationships in analogy.

a. Instrument and Measurement

Barometer : pleasure

Barometer is an instrument used to measure pleasure

Thermometer : temperature

Anemometer: Wind vane

Odometer: speed

Continued

Scale: length

Balance: mass

Ammeter: current

Screw Gauge: thickness

2. Quantity and Unit

Eg. length: meter

Meter is the unit of length

Mass: kilogram

3. Individual and group

Sailors: crew

A group of sailors is crew

4. Animal and young one

Eg cow: calf

Calf is the young one of cow

Rain Gauge: rain

hygrometer :Humidity

seismograph: earthquake

5. Male and female

eg horse: mare

male is female horse

6. individual and class

eg. lizard: reptile

lizard belongs to the class of reptile

7. individual and dwelling place

eg. Dog: kennel

Dog lives in a kennel

monk: monastery

Continued

8. Study and Topic

Eg,. Ornithology- birds

Ornithology is the study of birds

9. Worker and tool

Blacksmith – Anvil

It is the tool used by blacksmith

10. Tool and action

Eg. Needle: sew

Needle is used for sewing

11. Worker and working place

Eg. Chef: kitchen

A chef works in a kitchen

12. Worker and product

Eg. Masson: wall

13. product and rawmaterial

eg. Butter: milk

butter is from milk

14. part and whole relationship

eg. Room: window

window is part of room

15. Word and intensity

eg. Anger: rage

Rage is of higher intensity than anger

16. word and synonym

eg. blend-: mix

17. word and antonym

eg. Attack: defend

Continued

❖ Worthy of notice

Choosing the analogous word pair requires sequence of the given item

Eg chalk: blackboard

A. type: paint B. table : chair C. ink: paper D. paper: ink E door: handle

Eg2. interrupt: speak

A. shout: yell B. intrude: enter C. Interfere: assist D. concede :defend

Classification: word and letter classification

Classification means to assort the items of a given group on the basis of certain common quality they possess and then spot the stranger out

Eg choose the word which is least like the other words in the group

A. Curd B. butter C. oil D. cheese E. cream

Continued

Eg2. A. rose **B.** Lotus C. Marigold C Lily **D .** Tulip

Eg3. A. geometry B. Algebra C. Trigonometry **D.** mathematics E. arithmetic

Eg4. A. book B. paper C. pencil D. pen E. sharpener

Eg5. A. carrot B. potato .C. Tomato D. Ginger **E** Beetroot

ALPHABET/LETTER CLASSIFICATION

- In this type you have to identify an alphabet or a group of alphabets that are different from other given items.

- | | | | | |
|-------------------|---------------|---------|---------------|---------|
| 1. (A) KL | (B) OP | (C) AC | (D) NO | (E) WX |
| 2. (A) EV | (B) ZA | (C) CX | (D) DU | (E) YB |
| 3. (A) KMN | (B) BCD | (C) WXY | (D) PQR | (E) FGH |
| 4. (A) PU | (B) AO | (C) IZ | (D) KI | (E) LE |

Continued

- **Relationship based on position of letters/alphabets**
- 1. (C) Consecutive letters are there in all the other groups except 'C' where one letter has been skipped A(B)C.
- 2. (D) Here except 'D' all the other pairs consist of one letter from the beginning and one letter from the end of the alphabet series.
- 3. (A) Here except 'A' all the other groups consist of three consecutive letters. In 'A' one letter has been skipped K(L)MN.
- 4. (B) Here each pair consists of one consonant and one vowel, except in 'B' where both the letters are vowels.

Continued

- **II. Relationship based on small and capital letters**

- | | | | | |
|-------------|----------|----------|----------|----------|
| 5. (A) Bde | (B) Klm | (C) nOP | (D) Rst | (E) Cbk |
| 6. (A) AbC | (B) dEF | (C) GhI | (D) KlM | (E) PqR |
| 7. (A) ABcd | (B) EFgh | (C) ijKL | (D) MNop | (E) QRst |
| 8. (A) pQrS | (B) dEfG | (C) bCdE | (D) kLmN | (E) uvWX |

- **Answers and Explanations:**

- 5. (C) In each pair except 'C' consists of a capital letter in the beginning followed by two small letters; but in 'C' one small letter in the beginning followed by two capital letters.
- 6. (B) Here except 'B' all the other groups consist of a small letter in between two capital letters. In 'B' the small letter is in the beginning.
- 7. (C) All the other groups consist of two capital letters in the beginning followed by two small letters.
- 8. (E) In all the other groups every alternate letter is either small or capital. But in 'E' two consecutive letters in the beginning are small.

Continued

III. Relationship based on vowel and consonant

9. (A) KLMN (B) ABCD (C) EFGH (D) IJKL (E) UVWX

10. (A) PiQR (B) DoCK (C) AtCD (D) BuLK (E) CePT

11. (A) Bond (B) Ball (C) Pick (D) Talk (E) Boil

12. (A) TPDC (B) ONGC (C) KBFM (D) SMPK (E) TDMB

Answers and Explanations:

9. (A) In all the other groups there are vowels in the beginning. But in 'A' there is no vowel.

10. (C) In each group except 'C' every second letter is a vowel, but in 'C' the letters begin with a vowel.

11. (E) In each group except 'E' there is only one vowel but in 'E' there are two vowels, 'o' and 'i'.

12. (B) In each group except 'B' all the letters are consonant, but in 'B' there is one vowel (o).

Continued

IV. Relationship based on repetition and skipping pattern

13. (A) DDEEFF (B) KKLLMM (C) AABCDD (D) PPQQRR (E) MMNNOO

14. (A) BdFh (B) CeGi (C) NpRt (D) LnPr (E) IkLn

15. (A) RsuR (B) MnpR (C) BceG (D) KlnP (E) PqsU

16. (A) PaaD (B) TbbE (C) KmmP (D) LttE (E) BkkN

Answers and Explanations:

13. (C) In all the other groups letters are repeated except in (C), where the letter 'B' is not repeated.

14. (E) In each group except 'E', one letter has been skipped between each letter, e.g.

B(c)d(e)F(g)h., C(d)e(f)G(h)i, etc. But in 'E' it is not so—I(j)KL(m)n, i.e., no skipping between K and L.

Continued

- 15. (A) In all the other groups no letter has been repeated but in (A), the letter 'R' has been repeated.
- 16. (D) In all the other groups except (D), only two letters have been skipped between the 3rd and 4th letters, e.g., Paa(bc)D, Tbb(cd)E, etc., but in (D) ten letters have been skipped,—Ltt(uvwxyzabcd)E.
- What terms will fill the blank space? Z X V T R (---) (---)

Coding

1. Letter coding

The real alphabets in a word are replaced by certain other alphabets according to a specific rule to form its code. The candidate is required to detect the common rule and answer the questions accordingly.

Eg 1. if in a certain language MYSTIFY is coded as NZTUJGZ, how is NEMESIS coded in that language ?

A. MEDLHRDR **B.** OFNFTJT **C.** ODNHTDR **D.** PGOKUGU

continued

Each letter in the word MYSTIFY is moved one step forward to obtain the corresponding letter of the code

M	Y	S	T	I	F	Y
N	Z	T	U	J	G	Z

So in NEMESIS N will be coded as O, E as F; M as N and so on thus the answer is OFNFTJT. Hence the answer is B.

2) If TAP is coded as SZO, the how is FREEZE coded

A) EQDFYG B) ESDFYF C) GQFDYF D) EQDDYD

Each letter in the word TAP is moved one step backward to obtain the corresponding letter of the code

S	Z	O
T	A	P

continued

Thus in FREEZE F will be coded as E, R as Q; E as D; and Z as Y

So, the code becomes EQDDYD Hence, the answer is (d)

Number coding

Continued

- **NUMBER CODING**
- In these questions, either numerical code values are assigned to a word or alphabetical code letters are assigned to the numbers. The candidate is required to analyze the code as per the directions.
- **When numerical code values are assigned to words**
- **If in a certain language A is coded as 1. B is coded as 2, and so on , how is BIDDIC coded in that code?**
A. 294493 B. 284563 C. 375582 D. 394492
- **SOLUTION:** as given, the letters are coded as
- | | | | | | | | | |
|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|
| A | B | C | D | E | F | G | H | I |
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 |
-

Continued

So, in BIDDIC, B is coded as 2, I as 9 and D as 4 and C as 3. Thus BIDDIC is coded as 294493. Hence, the answer is A.

2. If PAINT is coded 74128 and EXCEL is coded as 93596, then how would you encode ACCEPT?

A. 455978 B. 547978 C. 554978 D. 735961

- Solution: clearly in the given code, the alphabets are coded as follows

P	A	I	N	T	E	X	C	L
7	4	1	2	8	9	3	5	6

- So, in ACCEPT A is coded as 4, C as 5, E as 9, P as 7, and T as 8. Hence the correct code is 455978 and therefore the answer is A.

Reading comprehension

- ❖ Reading Comprehension questions are designed to test a wide range of abilities required to read and understand. The abilities include:
 - understanding the meaning of individual words
 - understanding the meaning of individual sentences
 - understanding the meaning of paragraphs and larger bodies of text
 - distinguishing between minor and major points
 - summarizing a passage

Continued

- drawing conclusions from the information provided
- reasoning from incomplete data, inferring
- missing information
- understanding the structure of a text, how the
- parts relate to one another
- identifying the author's perspective
- analyzing a text and reaching conclusions about it
- identifying strengths and weaknesses

Continued

❖ **General Advice for Reading Comprehension Questions**

- Reading passages are drawn from many different disciplines and sources, so you may encounter material with which you are not familiar. Do not be discouraged when this happens; all the questions can be answered on the basis of the information provided in the passage, and you are not expected to rely on any outside knowledge.

Continued

- ❖ Read and analyze the passage carefully before trying to answer any of the questions, and pay attention to clues that help you understand less explicit aspects of the passage.
- ❖ Try to distinguish main ideas from supporting ideas or evidence.
- ❖ Try to distinguish ideas that the author is advancing from those he or she is merely reporting.
- ❖ Try to identify the relationship between different ideas.

Continued

❖ For example:

Are they contrasting? Are they consistent?

Does one support the other?

Does one spell another out in greater detail?

- ❖ Answer each question on the basis of the information provided in the passage and do not rely on outside knowledge.
- ❖ Sometimes your own views or opinions may conflict with those presented in a passage; if this happens, take special care to work within the context provided by the passage.

Continued

- ❖ Before you read the passage, read the questions at glance for few minutes
- ❖ Do not waste time reading the whole passage
- ❖ Read carefully the first paragraph of the passage and try to understand the key words
- ❖ Then move to the last paragraph and do accordingly
- ❖ Then go directly to the questions and refer the paragraph from which the question is drawn.

Vocabulary

- ❖ If you're in a testing situation and you are not allowed to use one, rely on the context clues in the sentence. The term *context clues* means that other words in the sentence “give away” or give clues to the definition. For example, sometimes you will find synonyms (words that mean the same thing) or antonyms (words that mean the opposite), or details that lead you to identify the vocabulary word in question. Once in a while, you will find a group of words set off by commas (called an appositive), which gives you a very clear definition of the word.

Exercise

- **Read the following sentences and try to choose the best definition for the italicized word by searching for context clues in the sentence.**

1. The designer window treatments in her house, installed 17 years ago, were *outmoded*.

a. unnecessary b. pointless c. out-of-date d. worthless

2. **The spies conducted a *covert* operation.**

a. Dangerous b. foreign c. hidden d. illegal

3. The baseball player's malice toward the referee was revealed in his *spiteful* remarks to the media, which almost ruined the referee's career.

a. Vindictive b. crazy c. rude d. unpleasant

Continued

4. Although Zachary is much too inexperienced for the managerial position, he is a willful young man and *obdurately* refuses to withdraw his application.

- **a.** foolishly **b.** reluctantly **c.** constantly **d.** stubbornly

5. His neighbor's *superficial* remarks trivialized the property line dispute and infuriated Malcolm.

- a. enraged **b.** petty **c.** insulting **d.** misleading

6. She showed a *blatant* disregard for the rules.

- a. Obvious **b.** hidden **c.** last-minute **d.** rebellious

7. Her fashion sense was usually described as *flamboyant*, but on the night of the party, Tanya's outfit was uncharacteristically modest.

- a.** Impeccable **b.** showy **c.** sloppy **d.** unassuming

Continued

8. Mr. Powers was so ***gullible*** that he believed even the most outlandish excuses of his insincere employees.

- a. Intelligent b. naïve c. dishonest d. critical

9. You cannot become a certified teacher without completing the ***prerequisite*** student-teaching assignment.

- a. Required b. optional c. preferred d. advisable

10. Charles, aware of his susceptibility to gum disease, is ***diligent*** about flossing.

- a. Uncomfortable b. excited c. thorough d. ambivalent

11. Even though she'd read her supervisor's memo four or five times, she still found his rambling message ***ambiguous***.

- a. Profound b. inspiring c. ridiculous d. unclear

Continued

12. The *intermittent* rain soaked the garden many different times during the day.

- a. protracted b. periodic c. incredulous d. light

13. I got a *vicarious* thrill watching you on the diving board.

- a. Shared b. unpleasant c. adventurous d. evil

14. After several small brushfires at the campground, officials felt the need to *augment* the rules pertaining to campfires.

- a. Criticize b. retract c. consider d. expand

15. 16. As soon as the details of the election were released to the media, the newspaper was *inundated* with calls—far too many to be handled effectively.

- a. Provided b. bothered c. rewarded d. flooded

Continued

16. The doctor got to the *crux* of the issue.

- a. Outline b. opposite c. crucial point d. unhealthy

17. When people heard that timid Bob had taken up skydiving, they were *incredulous*.

- a. Fearful b. outraged c. convinced d. disbelieving

18. The preacher used a *euphemism* for an unpleasant subject.

- a. ugly picture b. substituted word c. homeless person d. visual aid

19. That perfume always *evokes* pleasant memories.

- a. Angers b. erases c. calls up d. confuses

Part One :Analogy Questions

- **Directions:** Questions 1-16 deal with verbal analogy questions. Four pairs of words or phrases follow a related pair of words written in capital letters. Select the pair that best expresses a relationship similar to that expressed in the original capitalized pair.

1.**PAINTER** is to **GALLERY** as **ARTIST** is to:

A.Theatre B.Comedy C. Drama D. Art

2.**MECHANIC** is to **GARAGE** as **FARMER** is to:

A. Farm B. Harvest C. Field D. Produce

3.**CHEF** is to **KITCHEN** as **ACTOR** is to:

A. Concert B. Performance C. Drama D. Stage

Continued

4. PESTICIDE is to CROP as ANTISEPTIC is to:

A. Wound B. Clotting C. Bandage D. Blood

5.VICTORY is to ENCOURAGEMENT as FAILURE is to:

A. Sadness B. Frustration C. Anger D. moralization

7.MUSLIMS is to MOSQUE as JEWS is to:

A. Gurudwara B. Synagogues C .Church D. Cathedral

8. RACE: TRACK

A. Tennis: Court B. Hockey : Arena C. Shirt: Garment

D. Badminton : Ring

Continued

9.DEARTH: SCARCITY

A. Axe: Grind B. Gun: Shoot C. Substitute : Replace D. Pen: Write

10.CHAOS: PEACE

A. Turbulence: Order B. Unrest: Strife

C. Turmoil: Havok

D. Aggression: Hostility

11.PLANT : SEED

A. Bud : Flower B. Trunk : Tree C. Fruit : Twig D. Leaf: Root

12. PAIN:SEDATIVE

A. Ache : Examination B. Grief : Consolation C. Depression : Aggression

D. Comfort : Stimulant

Continued

13. CONTAMINATION : FOOD

A. Infection : Body B. Pain : Relief C. Germ: Disease D. Heath : Disease

14. LAWLESS : ORDER A. Jail: Prison B.Hostage: Detained

C. Trouble: Punishment D. Captive: Freedom

15. LIQUID : LITER (A)Mercury: Thermometer C)Distance: Kilometer

(B) Flight: yard (D) Water: Glass

16. ANESTHESIA: ANESTHETIC (A) Patient: Doctor (C) Biology: Life

(B) Physics: Physicist (D) University: Academics

Continued

17. POND: OCEAN

(A) River: Rapids (C) Aquarium :Fish

(B) Land: Train D. Pebble : Boulder

18.DUBIOUS: INCONTROVEITABLE

- (A) Defamation: Disparagement (C) Rapacious: Generous
- (B) Painful: Tantalizing (D) Perspicacious: Tenacity

Sentence completion

Directions: Four alternatives (A), (B), (C) and (D) are given for each (Items 33-47).
Select the alternative that fills best in the blank/blanks in the sentence and blacken the
letter of your choice on the separate answer sheet provided.

1. The weather was awful since it rained all weekend. We were----- wet and I began to wish that I had stayed at home,

(A) Foggily C. Streaming (B) Soaking D. absolutely

2. Flies, priests and lights can ----- any house.

(A) pass (B) enter C. see D. build

Continued

3. 'After sitting in the sink for several days, the dirty, food-encrusted dishes became----

(A) emphatic (C) prevalent { (B) perforated (D) malodorous

4. The ----- of a mental disorder can be brought about by some form of chemical imbalance or a traumatic event such as war or the death of a partner.

conclusion (B) onset (C) set up (D) symptom

5. It was----- to think that it could possibly snow in the middle of the desert.

(A) advantageous (C) preventative (B) philosophical D. preposterous

6. She wrote in her ----- that her mom used to buy her cream at a local

(A) dairy/diary B) diary/ dairy (C)'dairy/ dairy (D) diary/ diary

Continued

6. Mary became -----at typing because she practiced every day for six months.

(A) proficient (B)

(B) reflective (C) effective (D) redundant

7. Roman's glance was ----- invitation to speak later in private about events of the meeting. (A) treacherous (B) scintillating (C) tactful (D) taboo

8. She hadn't eaten all day, and by the time she got home she was -----

• (A) blighted (B) confutative (C) ravenous (D) ostentatious

Continued

9. The children----- their home work before they ----- to play.

A. did/ has done B. has done/ had done C have done/ have done E none.

10. There are forty students in my class. All but 10 passed. The equivalent sentence for this statement is that:

A. 10 students failed B. 30 students failed C 10 students passed E. 20 students passed

11. If she had got her father, she would have not been abnormal. This is equivalent to

A. she got her father and got mad B. she does no get her father and became abnormal
C. She did not get her father and she became abnormal.
D. She got her father but she has become abnormal

Continued

12. Which one of the following sentence is correct?

A. I have bought a car yester day. B. She got married yesterday

B. C. She can told him D. He was a accused in murdering

13. My mother ----- when I----- the clothes.

A. Was coming./washed was coming / washed C has coming/ have washed

D came/ was/washing

14. Cross out the wrong one

A Beautiful woman B. I bought a she goat C. handsome money

D. Pretty boy Charming name

Good Luck